

COGNITIVE BEHAVIORAL THERAPY (CBT) – SESSION 13

New Case: Rohan (26 y/o) – Contamination OCD + Checking

Highly Detailed – Realistic Style

SESSION INFORMATION

Client:	Rohan (26 years, Male, Software Engineer, Bangalore)	Therapist:	Dr. A.
Session #:	13 of 18–20	Focus:	Continuing ERP + Relapse Prevention Planning

PRE-SESSION THERAPIST NOTES

Client arrived looking more confident and engaged than previous sessions. He practiced the public surface exposure at home 1 time with good habituation. He reported that anxiety is decreasing faster with repeated practice and that he is delaying other compulsions more consistently. He continues to use labeling effectively. Today's plan: Review home ERP practice in detail, continue ERP if needed, deepen relapse prevention planning (Early Warning Signs + Action Plan), reinforce progress and coping skills, and assign new homework. Maintain supportive and encouraging approach.

SESSION START – HOMEWORK REVIEW

Therapist: Good morning, Rohan. How has your week been? I'm curious to hear how the public surface exposure practice at home went and what you thought about your Early Warning Signs.

Client: (speaking with more confidence) It went quite well. I practiced it one time. Anxiety went up to around 65–70 and took about 20–22 minutes to come down significantly. I was able to resist washing for over 30 minutes. It was hard at first, but the anxiety came down gradually. I also thought about my Early Warning Signs. I noticed that when OCD starts getting stronger, I wash more often, check switches more, and start avoiding certain places or people. I also become more irritable and tired.

Therapist: That's excellent continued progress with the exposure, and very good insight into your Early Warning Signs. Recognizing these signals early is crucial for maintaining your gains. You mentioned washing more, checking more, avoiding situations, and feeling more irritable and tired. These are classic signs that OCD might be trying to regain strength. How does it feel to have identified them?

Client: It feels helpful. I think if I notice these signs early, I can take action before things get too bad again.

DEEPENING RELAPSE PREVENTION PLANNING

Therapist: That's exactly the goal. Now that we've identified some of your Early Warning Signs, let's start building your ****Action Plan**** — what you will actually do when you notice these signs appearing. This is something you can use even after therapy ends. Would that be okay?

Client: Yes, I want to have a clear plan.

Therapist: Great. Let's develop your Action Plan together. This is what you will do when Early Warning Signs appear for more than a few days:

Action Plan we developed together:

1. Increase use of labeling and coping skills (urge surfing, breathing) immediately
2. Review your Exposure Hierarchy and practice one or two items that feel relevant
3. Increase monitoring of washing/checking for 1 week to track any increase
4. If symptoms do not improve after 7–10 days or significantly affect daily life → Contact therapist for a booster session

Client: This feels practical. I like having something concrete to do if things start getting worse again.

Therapist: That's the idea. We'll continue refining this plan over the next few sessions so you feel fully equipped when therapy ends.

HOMEWORK ASSIGNMENT

Therapist: For this week:

1. Continue practicing the public surface exposure at home (1 time)
2. Continue practicing previous hierarchy items as needed
3. Continue labeling and monitoring
4. Review your Early Warning Signs list and Action Plan daily (even if just for 1 minute)

Client: I'll try reviewing the plan daily. I want to make sure I remember what to do if things start getting worse.

Therapist: Excellent. We'll review everything next session.

SESSION SUMMARY & FEEDBACK

Therapist: Today we reviewed your strong progress at home, discussed your Early Warning Signs in detail, and started building your Action Plan for relapse prevention. How are you feeling about today's session?

Client: I feel good. I like having a clear plan for what to do if OCD starts coming back. It makes me feel more confident about maintaining my progress after therapy ends.

Therapist: That's wonderful to hear. Any questions before we finish?

Client: Not really.

POST-SESSION THERAPIST NOTES

- Client showed continued strong progress in ERP and good insight into his Early Warning Signs.
- Relapse prevention planning (Early Warning Signs + Action Plan) was well received and collaboratively developed.
- Client expressed increased confidence in maintaining gains post-therapy.
- Next session: Review home ERP practice and Action Plan use, continue ERP if needed, deepen relapse prevention planning, reinforce coping skills and self-compassion.

Disclaimer: This is a completely fictional but realistic simulation created solely for educational and AI training purposes. It does not represent any real person or therapy.